NORTHSTAR TECHNOLOGIES

Engineering & Developer Onboarding

Development environment, code quality, reviews, and release safety

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Owner	People Operations / relevant department
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Important: Fictional sample company and policy pack created for OnboardIQ demonstration and ingestion testing. These documents are not legal advice and are not actual company policies. Replace with approved company content before real use.

1. First steps for engineers

- Meet your engineering manager or team lead and confirm the services, repositories, and systems relevant to your role.
- Read the service overview, architecture diagram, local setup guide, coding standards, and team runbook before changing production systems.
- Request repository, cloud, database, and deployment access through the approved workflow. Use least privilege and separate production access where required.

2. Development environment

- Follow the maintained setup guide for language versions, package managers, environment variables, databases, and local services.
- Use a local environment file for development secrets and ensure it is excluded from version control. Never commit real API keys, tokens, private keys, or production credentials.
- Use approved package registries and review dependencies for maintenance, licensing, and security concerns.
- Document setup problems with exact error messages and the steps required to reproduce them.

3. Git and code review

- Create a branch for a focused change and keep commits small enough to review.
- Describe the purpose, design, testing, and risk of a pull request. Link relevant tickets and screenshots where useful.
- Do not approve your own change if the process requires independent review.
- Resolve review feedback respectfully and explain any proposed alternative.
- Avoid committing generated files, local secrets, personal data, or unrelated changes.

4. Testing and quality

- Add or update tests for behavior that changes. Run relevant unit, integration, and end-to-end checks before requesting approval.
- Review edge cases, error handling, logging, performance, accessibility, and security impact.
- Do not use real customer or employee data in development unless explicitly authorized and protected by the required controls.
- A passing test suite does not replace code review or required security checks.

5. Deployments and incidents

- Follow the team's approved release process, deployment windows, approvals, and rollback procedure.
- Do not make untracked production changes or bypass required review because a change appears urgent.
- Monitor relevant metrics and logs after deployment. Confirm expected behavior and communicate completion.
- For an incident, prioritize user impact and safe recovery, follow the incident commander or runbook, and document actions and decisions.

6. Example engineering workflow

Step	Expected action
Understand	Read ticket, clarify acceptance criteria, identify owners and risks.
Design	Choose a simple solution and document meaningful trade-offs.
Implement	Make a focused change using team conventions.
Validate	Run tests, linters, and relevant security checks.
Review	Open pull request and address feedback.
Release	Use approved pipeline and rollback plan.
Learn	Monitor results and update documentation if needed.

7. Useful questions to ask your team

- Where is the service architecture documented?
- How do I run tests locally and in CI?
- Which logs and dashboards should I use?
- Who approves production changes?
- What is the rollback process?
- Where do I report a vulnerability or security concern?

End of Engineering & Developer Onboarding. This is fictional demonstration content for OnboardIQ.